

Jiyoon Pyo

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Research Interest

Geospatial AI, Multimodal reasoning, Spatial understanding, Human-centered AI applications

Education

University of Minnesota - Twin Cities <i>Ph.D. in Computer Science</i> ◦ Advisor: Prof. Yao-Yi Chiang	<i>Sept 2023 – Present</i>
University of Minnesota - Twin Cities <i>M.Sc. in Computer Science</i>	<i>Sept 2023 – May 2025</i>
The Cooper Union <i>M.Eng. in Electrical Engineering</i> ◦ Advisor: Prof. Carl Sable ◦ Thesis: Detection and Replacement of Neologisms for Translation (ProQuest 🔗)	<i>Aug 2019 – May 2023</i>
The Cooper Union <i>B.Eng. in Electrical Engineering (Computer Engineering)</i> ◦ Minor: Computer Science	<i>Aug 2019 – May 2023</i>

Publications

Where's the Chicken? Unpacking Spatial Awareness in Vision-Language Models <i>Jiyoon Pyo</i> , Yao-Yi Chiang The Blogpost Track at ICLR 2026 🔗	Apr 2026
FRIEDA: Benchmarking Multi-Step Cartographic Reasoning in Vision-Language Models <i>Jiyoon Pyo</i> , Yuankun Jiao, Dongwon Jung, Zekun Li, Leeje Jang, Sofia Kirsanova, Jina Kim, Yijun Lin, Qin Liu, Junyi Xie, Hadi Askari, Nan Xu, Muhao Chen, Yao-Yi Chiang Preprint, Accepted to ICLR2026 🔗	Oct 2025
Augmenting Human-Centered Racial Covenant Detection and Georeferencing with Plug-and-Play NLP Pipelines <i>Jiyoon Pyo</i> , Yuankun Jiao, Yao-Yi Chiang, Michael Corey ACM SIGSPATIAL GeoHCC 2025 🔗	Sept 2025
Exploiting LLMs and Semantic Technologies to Build a Knowledge Graph of Historical Mining Data Craig A. Knoblock, Binh Vu, Basel Shbita, Yao-Yi Chiang, Pothula Punith Krishna, Xiao Lin, Goran Muric, <i>Jiyoon Pyo</i> , Adriana Trejo-Sheu, Meng Ye International Semantic Web Conference 2025 🔗	July 2025
Leveraging Large Language Models for Generating Labeled Mineral Site Record Linkage Data <i>Jiyoon Pyo</i> , Yao-Yi Chiang ACM SIGSPATIAL GeoAI 2024 🔗	July 2024

Research Experience

Graduate Researcher

Oak Ridge National Lab

*Oak Ridge, TN
May 2026 - Aug 2026*

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Minnesota - Knowledge Computing Lab

*Minneapolis, MN
Fall 2023 - Present*

Research Intern

Reykjavik University - Language and Voice Lab

*Reykjavik, Iceland
May 2022 - Aug 2022*

- Contributed to the Icelandic Language Technology 2018-2022 project by researching natural language processing (NLP) techniques for Icelandic
- Collaborated with IcelandAir to develop a [multilingual customer survey sentiment analysis tool](#) 
- Evaluated the performance of IceBERT against RoBERTa and XLNet for analyzing customer feedback across different languages

Technologies

Languages: Python, C++, C, Java, JavaScript

Database/Big Data: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Spark, MongoDB